

	AIK	FreeBSD	HP-UX	Irix	Linux	Mac OS X	NetBSD	OpenBSD	Solaris	Tru64 UNIX	Windows
Physical Interfaces											
ATM	Unknown	Unknown	Unknown	Unknown	Yes	No	Unknown	Unknown	Yes	Unknown	Unknown
Bluetooth	No	No	No	No	Yes	No	No	No	No	No	No
CircleIDLC	Unknown	Yes	Unknown	Unknown	Yes	Unknown	Yes	Yes	Unknown	Unknown	Unknown
Ethernet	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
FDDB	Unknown	Unknown	Unknown	Unknown	Yes	No	Unknown	Unknown	Yes	Unknown	Unknown
FrameRelay	Unknown	Unknown	No	No	Yes	No	Unknown	Unknown	No	No	No
IrDA	No	No	No	No	Yes	No	No	No	No	No	No
PPP	Unknown	Unknown	Unknown	Unknown	Yes	Yes	Unknown	Unknown	No	Unknown	Yes
TokamiLine	Yes	Yes	Unknown	No	Yes	No	Yes	Yes	Yes	Unknown	No
USB	No	No	No	No	Yes	No	No	No	No	No	No
WLAN	Unknown	Yes	Unknown	Unknown	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Unknown	Unknown	Yes
Virtual Interfaces											
Loopback	Unknown	Yes	No	Unknown	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	Yes	N/A
VLAN Tag	Yes	Yes	Yes	Unknown	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes

Figure 1: Network types supported on various platforms by Wireshark

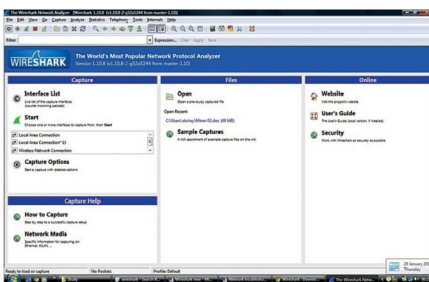


Figure 2: Home screen for Wireshark for Windows 32-bit

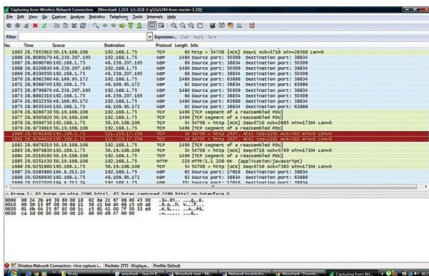


Figure 3: Live packet capture in action using Wireshark

needed, decodes its raw data, showing the values of various fields in the packet and analyses its content. Packet capture is the process of intercepting and logging traffic.

Wireshark runs on GNU/Linux, OS X, BSD, Solaris, some other UNIX-like operating systems and Microsoft Windows. There is also a terminal based (non-GUI) version called TShark. Wireshark and other programs distributed with it such as TShark are free software, released under the terms of the GNU General Public Licence. The network types supported on various platforms by Wireshark are shown in Figure 1.

Wireshark is very similar to tcpdump (a common packet analyser that runs under the command line) but has a graphical front-end, plus some integrated sorting and filtering options.

Features of Wireshark

Data can be captured 'from the wire' from a live network connection, or read from a file of already-captured packets. Live data can be read from various types of networks including Ethernet, IEEE 802.11 and PPP. Captured network data can be browsed via a GUI or via the terminal (command line) version of the utility, TShark. Captured files can be programmatically edited or converted via command-line switches to the editcap program. Data display can be refined using a display filter.

Plugins can be created for dissecting new protocols. Voice over Internet Protocol (VoIP) calls in the captured traffic can be detected. If encoded in compatible encoding, media flow can even be played. Raw USB traffic can be captured, packets on many criteria filtered/searched and captured packet data saved.

Getting started with Wireshark

To get started with Wireshark, follow the steps given below:

1. Wireshark can be downloaded from its official website link www.wireshark.org.